

fixtures/backstop/¹⁰ – T (SpecKit- "fast-dev- cycles", plan T-C)

Fixtures proving `constitution/scripts/fastcycle/gates/backstop.sh` (not yet implemented — T077, plan task T-C10) will correctly implement:

1. **DEC-17's drift rule** (research.md line 654 / plan.md T-C10 Work line): the full backstop lane (every gate, `--no-cache`, no `--affected` narrowing) is compared against the fast lane's verdicts for the SAME change; any gate the full lane FAILED but the fast lane did not also report FAIL for (whether the gate was never selected at all — a "selection hole" — or was selected but reported a different verdict) is a **drift**, a release blocker, and MUST block (exit 1).
2. **constitution SS11.4.226's guard-freshness queue**, drained most-reopened-first per SS11.4.189, `then stalest-first`.

No dedicated contract exists for T-C (confirmed, not assumed)

`specs/004-fast-dev-cycles/contracts/common-conventions.md` 's "Tool map" section explicitly lists `$FC/gates/backstop.sh` (T-C10) among the tools for which "no contract is invented here ... their interface, output and RED fixtures are fixed by the plan task text until a contract is written." A real `ls specs/004-fast-dev-cycles/contracts/*.md` at authoring time confirms no `backstop*.md` (or similarly-named) contract file exists. The CLI wire format this fixture set and the RED test assume is therefore **this file's own definition, binding-if-adopted on T-C10's implementer**, following this project's established house precedent (`fixtures/mutation_reuse/README.md` 's identical final section; `test_verdict_cache_red.sh` 's header comment).

Two closely-related, already-existing contracts this design reuses

- `affected-set-and-verdict-cache.md` 's "Output schemas" section already defines the `verdicts/v1` document shape (`{change_id, results: [{gate_id, verdict, source, evidence, duration_ms}], summary}`) — `bs_selection_hole/` and `bs_negctrl_equal/` reuse this SAME shape for both `fast_verdicts.json` and `full_verdicts.json` , rather than inventing a new schema for `backstop.sh` (constitution SS11.4.6 — do not invent when something adjacent already exists). That same contract's `VC-005` (backstop) clause states the special case DEC-17 generalises: "any gate PASS in fast lane but FAIL in full lane is a release blocker."
- `catch-set-comparison-harness.md` 's `C-001` -family exit-code convention (0 clean, 1 a finding/release-blocker, 2 usage, 3 self-test/needle failure, 4 BLIND) is followed by the CLI contract below, matching every other tool in this suite (`common-conventions.md` `C-001`).

Scenario fixtures

Directory	Covers
<code>bs_selection_hole/</code>	golden-bad: a planted fast-lane selection hole → DRIFT report naming the gate → block (exit 1)
<code>bs_negctrl_equal/</code>	negative control: equal fast/full selections, including a real shared FAIL → NO_DRIFT (exit 0)
<code>bs_freshness_queue/</code>	guard-freshness queue drained most-reopened-first (then stalest-first), a fresh guard excluded despite the highest <code>reopens_count</code>

Reference computations (Section B / Section C of the RED test)

- `../lib/dec17_drift_ref.py` — this project's own from-scratch reference implementation of DEC-17's drift rule, used to prove `bs_selection_hole/` and `bs_negctrl_equal/` are non-vacuous BEFORE any claim is made about the absent real tool.
- `../lib/guard_freshness_ref.py` — this project's own from-scratch reference implementation of the SS11.4.226/SS11.4.189 freshness-queue ordering rule, used to prove `bs_freshness_queue/` is non-vacuous BEFORE any claim is made about the absent real tool.

Neither reference module is imported by, or informs the design of, T-C10's real implementation (Producer != Verifier, constitution SS11.4.240).

The invented CLI wire format (binding-if-adopted)

```

$FC/gates/backstop.sh run --config <cfg> --no-cache --out
<full_verdicts.json>
# Runs $FC/gates/gate_runner.sh over EVERY gate (--no-cache, no
# --affected narrowing) -- reuses gate_runner.sh's verdicts/v1 output
# schema unchanged. NOT exercised by this RED test (it composes
# gate_runner.sh + a real gate corpus, neither of which this
# fixture-driven RED test constructs; T077's own implementer-task
# job, Producer != Verifier SS11.4.240).

$FC/gates/backstop.sh compare --fast <fast_verdicts.json> --full
<full_verdicts.json> --out <drift.json> [--apply --map <gate_map.json>]
# DEC-17 drift = a gate_id whose FULL verdict is FAIL and whose FAST
# verdict is anything other than FAIL (absent -- selection hole -- or
# PASS/SKIP/BLIND -- stale/wrong verdict). Exit 0: no drift found
# (stdout first line "NO_DRIFT"). Exit 1: >=1 drift found (stdout one
# "DRIFT gate=<id> fast=<verdict|ABSENT> full=FAIL" line per drifting
# gate, sorted by gate_id, then "DRIFT_COUNT=<n>") -- exit 1 IS the
# block (C-001: code 1 = "a finding ... release blocker"; DEC-17:
# "a drift ... is a release blocker"). --out writes a
# backstop_drift/v1 document (schema, body_hash, drift[], drift_count,
# run_meta per C-002). The optional --apply --map <gate_map.json>
# pair (C-006: writes are behind an explicit --apply flag) marks each
# drifting gate's affected-set map entry `force-full` per DEC-17/
# AS-010a -- NOT exercised by this RED test's fixtures (it crosses
# into T-C03's own map format; this file's scope is DEC-17's
# detect-and-block rule alone, Producer != Verifier SS11.4.240).

$FC/gates/backstop.sh freshness-queue --registry <registry.json> --
fingerprint <fp> --out <queue.json>
# Drains the SS11.4.226 guard-freshness queue. A guard is STALE
# (queued) iff its stored last_verdict_fingerprint != <fp> (including
# never-executed -- absent/empty fingerprint, maximally stale); a
# guard whose stored fingerprint MATCHES <fp> is FRESH and excluded
# from the queue regardless of reopens_count. Queue order:
# reopens_count descending (SS11.4.189 most-reopened-first) PRIMARY,
# staleness descending (older/absent last_verdict_at first, "then
# stalest-first" per SS11.4.226) SECONDARY tie-break only. Exit 0
# always (an ordering emission, not a pass/fail judgement). stdout:
# one "QUEUE <rank> guard=<id> reopens=<n>" line per queued guard IN
# DRAIN ORDER, then "FRESH_COUNT=<n>" "STALE_COUNT=<m>". Exit 2 usage
# error.

```

What this RED test does NOT cover

- The `run` subcommand's actual full-corpus execution (composes `gate_runner.sh` + a real gate/mutation corpus, neither constructed by this fixture-driven RED test — T077's own implementer-task job).
- The `--apply --map <gate_map.json>` write-back that marks a drifting gate's map entry `force-full` (AS-010a) — that crosses into T-C03's own map format and is that contract's/test's scope (`test_affected_set_red.sh`), not T-C10's (Producer != Verifier SS11.4.240).
- The release-tag-time / nightly-on- `main` / gate-engine-change scheduling triggers DEC-17 names for WHEN the full lane runs — this RED test covers only the COMPARISON + BLOCK behaviour and the freshness-queue drain order, both of which are agnostic to what triggered the run.
- The CLI wire format above is UNCONFIRMED by any `contracts/*.md` file (none exists for T-C10 at the time this file was written — confirmed by a real directory listing and `common-conventions.md` 's own explicit "open gap" listing, not assumed) and is DEFINED here, binding-if-adopted, per this project's established house precedent.